

PROJECT HISTORY AND ARCHITECTURAL OVERVIEW

Building the New Just One Look Website

The journey from preservation and migration to Zero, privacy-first measurement,
and the All Roads Lead to Zero Initiative

A concise record of the ideas that shaped the project

August 2026

The project in one view

The new website grew in stages, but the central idea stayed constant: make the invitation itself easy to encounter, preserve the depth of the work, and keep the technology quieter than the message.

Stage	What changed
1. Foundation	A GitHub-based prototype established a durable home for the Method, documentation, and collaborative work.
2. Migration	The tested site was rebuilt as a simple static publication, while the old site was preserved as historical source material.
3. Design	The homepage was organized around a human sequence: look first, ask “What Now?” next, then explore the Library or Forum.
4. Launch	The tested build moved into the production repository and the domain justonelook.org went live.
5. Zero	Two deliberately separate AI guides became native website experiences: Step One and Step Two.
6. Measurement	A private dashboard added aggregate, privacy-first traffic and Looking Zero outcome signals.
7. Roads to Zero	Clean outreach URLs began showing which approved public roads are being opened, without tracking individual journeys.
8. Simplification	Shared Zero assets, canonical instructions, tests, and documentation were consolidated around one production architecture.

The ideas that remained constant

- The invitation comes before explanation.
- Step One and Step Two are companions, but each has one responsibility.
- The Library preserves source material; the Forum carries living conversation.
- Public pages should be calm, direct, mobile-friendly, and easy to maintain.
- Measurement should answer useful questions without creating personal profiles.
- The repository should preserve not only code, but the reasoning behind the project.

Stage 1 — Establishing a durable foundation

The earliest work treated the website as an ongoing publication rather than a one-time design exercise.

GitHub provided a stable place to draft the Method, test themes and navigation, improve wording, and document how the work should be maintained. That mattered because the site was never only a collection of pages. It was becoming a long-lived public home for an active body of work.

Why GitHub suited the project

- History: every meaningful change can be traced, compared, and, when necessary, reversed.
- Safe experimentation: branches allow one focused idea to be developed without disturbing the live site.
- Review: pull requests make the intended change visible before it is merged.
- Continuity: instructions, design choices, and maintenance notes can live beside the code instead of remaining only in conversation.
- Simple publishing: GitHub Pages turns the approved main branch into the public static website.
- Preservation: legacy material can remain in the repository even when it is excluded from publication.
- Reproducibility: another maintainer—or a coding agent—can inspect the same files, rules, tests, and history.

An important operational boundary

GitHub Pages publishes the static website. Zero's Cloudflare Worker is deployed separately, so merging website changes does not silently redeploy the AI backend. This separation makes production changes more deliberate.

Stage 2 — Migration without erasure

The large migration phase took place in a test repository before the production move. Existing articles, books, recordings, videos, blog posts, and podcasts were reviewed and reorganized rather than copied blindly. The aim was to preserve the work while removing accidental duplication and making the collection understandable to a new visitor.

The historical site was retained under a dedicated legacy area and excluded from publication. This created a useful distinction: the current website could become simpler without pretending the earlier website had never existed.

A clearer division of roles

- The website is the stable public publication.
- The Library is the organized home for books, articles, blog posts, podcasts, audio reports, and videos.
- The Forum is an external Discourse community for conversation, not a discussion database inside the static website.
- The legacy site is preserved source material, not part of routine publishing.

Stage 3 — Designing the visitor's journey

The central design decision was not a color or a layout. It was the order in which a visitor meets the work.

The new homepage puts the inward look near the beginning. Explanation remains available, but it no longer has to be completed before the visitor can try the essential act. After the look, “What Now?” becomes the natural next question. The Library and Forum then offer depth, context, and connection without competing with the first invitation.

The intended public sequence

1. Encounter the invitation to look.
2. Use Looking Zero when direct guidance is helpful.
3. Continue to “What Now?” and Step Two when appropriate.
4. Explore the Library for the broader body of work.
5. Use the Forum for community conversation.

The visual language supports this sequence through restraint: generous space, clear typography, a limited blue palette, the Just One Look identity, and Zero as a friendly guide rather than a dominant technical product. Navigation is meant to remain predictable on desktop and mobile, while legal and operational links stay available without overwhelming the primary path.

Stage 4 — Moving into production

After the test site had been reviewed, the tested build moved into the production repository in early August 2026. The custom domain, canonical URLs, metadata, sitemap, robots rules, social previews, and custom 404 page were part of turning a collection of pages into a coherent public website.

This launch also clarified ownership. The production repository became the canonical home for current website code and content; the earlier test repository became historical. From that point onward, focused branches, validation, pull requests, and review formed the normal maintenance process.

The website today — short structural view

Area	Role
Root pages	Homepage, About, Contact, Forum, legal pages, and the main visitor journey.
library/	Books, articles, blog posts, podcasts, audio reports, and videos.
assets/	Shared brand images, photographs, styles, scripts, and social graphics.
try-it/	Canonical public page for Look At Yourself — Step One.
self-directed-attention/	Canonical public page for the Self-Directed Attention Exercise — Step Two.
zero/	Canonical behavior and teaching instructions for both guides.
worker/zero/	Shared Cloudflare Worker backend, API routes, measurement logic, tests, and deployment tooling.
try-it/x/	Current public Road to Zero entry URL for X.

Stage 5 — From external GPTs to Zero on the website

Zero evolved from two companion Custom GPTs into a native part of justonelook.org.

The original guides established a crucial separation of responsibilities. Look At Yourself guides Step One: the inward look. The Self-Directed Attention Exercise guides Step Two and assumes that Step One has already been performed. Neither guide should quietly absorb the work of the other.

Bringing the guides onto the website made the experience easier to find, gave the project control over the public presentation, and allowed privacy, limits, testing, and measurement to be designed as one coherent system. The current architecture shares infrastructure where sharing is useful, while keeping behavior and routes distinct.

The current Zero architecture

Layer	Location	Responsibility
Instructions	zero/	The canonical source of truth for each guide's behavior and boundaries.
Runtime	worker/zero/	Builds the instructions and serves two separate API routes with guide-specific settings.
Public pages	/try-it/ and /self-directed-attention/	Two canonical browser experiences using shared Zero interface assets.

Canonical public destinations

Look At Yourself — Step One: <https://justonelook.org/try-it/>

Self-Directed Attention Exercise — Step Two: <https://justonelook.org/self-directed-attention/>

Privacy and safety by design

- Conversations are sent to the OpenAI API with storage disabled.
- The site does not maintain a conversation database or user accounts.
- Origin checks, rate limits, message limits, and guide-specific boundaries protect the public service.
- The two guides use separate API routes and remain behaviorally separate even though they share infrastructure.
- Canonical Markdown instructions, generated runtime modules, and automated tests reduce drift and accidental duplication.

Stage 6 — Building a useful, private dashboard

The dashboard was created to support stewardship, not surveillance.

Once Zero became part of the website, the project needed a way to learn whether people were reaching it, beginning conversations, receiving the complete invitation, and reporting anything that might indicate they had tried. The answer was a private dashboard based on anonymous aggregate counts and tightly limited session records—not conventional marketing profiles.

What the dashboard helps the team understand

- Website traffic, including homepage activity and key invitations into Zero.
- How many Looking Zero sessions begin and how far the conversational invitation is delivered.
- Whether a later message contains a possible or explicit report of trying the inward look.
- How the selected date range changes those aggregate totals.
- Which approved Roads to Zero links are being opened.

What it does not show

- It does not identify a visitor or build a personal profile.
- It does not store conversation text, IP addresses, names, accounts, or browser fingerprints.
- It does not prove that an inward look occurred; it can only classify what was reported in the conversation.
- It does not connect a source-road count to later homepage activity, a Zero conversation, or an outcome report.
- It is not a person-level funnel. The figures belong to separate aggregate measurement layers.

How to read the dashboard responsibly

Use the dashboard to notice broad patterns, compare date ranges, and improve outreach or guidance. Do not turn aggregate counts into claims about individual journeys, success rates, or causal effects that the system does not observe.

The measurement philosophy

The design favors data minimization. A short-lived, one-way session hash can support limited operational and outcome measurement without preserving identity or message content. Older detail gives way to daily aggregates. A separate classifier may categorize reports for measurement, but it cannot change Zero's response and also operates with storage disabled.

Stage 7 — The All Roads Lead to Zero Initiative

The initiative gives outreach a simple public vocabulary while preserving the project's privacy commitments.

General outreach should lead to Step One first. Instead of placing long tracking links in social posts, each approved platform receives a short, readable address on justonelook.org. Opening that address records one anonymous aggregate source count and immediately continues to Looking Zero at the canonical [/try-it/](#) page.

Road	Public URL
X	https://justonelook.org/try-it/x/

How it connects to the dashboard

The private dashboard presents the X road count under Roads to Zero for the selected date range. This allows the team to see whether the current X outreach is helping bring attention toward Zero. The road total sits alongside other website and Zero figures, but it remains a separate layer.

An X road opening is not joined to a homepage view, a Zero session, an invitation, or an indication of trying. The dashboard therefore cannot say that a particular person arrived from X and later performed the inward look. It can only say how often the X road was opened during the period.

The privacy logic

- No visitor identity is created.
- No cookie, fingerprint, referrer profile, or linked journey is stored.
- Only an approved source label and an aggregate daily count are needed.
- A post specifically about Step Two, intended for people who have already looked, may link directly to the canonical Step Two page instead.

Why the source folder sits under try-it/

GitHub Pages maps the x/ source folder under try-it/ to its clean public address. Keeping x/ beneath try-it/ makes its relationship to the canonical Looking Zero page explicit. The source-entry page uses the shared source script and Worker measurement path. Additional source folders can be added in the same pattern when a new outreach link is actually needed.

Stage 8 — Consolidation and the next phase

The latest work has focused on making the production architecture match the conceptual simplicity of the site.

Shared Zero styling and browser behavior now use guide-neutral names, and pilot-era access code logic and unnecessary browser memory have been removed. Canonical instructions generate the Worker's runtime modules; tests protect guide separation, public routes, privacy boundaries, and safe internal links. The asset tree has also been clarified: shared styles, brand graphics, and general photographs now have distinct homes, while content-specific imagery remains tied to its content role.

What GitHub now preserves

- The published website and its stable public paths.
- The canonical instructions that define Zero's two roles.
- The Worker code, tests, and operational documentation.
- The Library and the preserved historical website source.
- The reasoning behind privacy, measurement, outreach, and maintenance choices.
- A reviewable record of how the project developed over time.

The guiding principle going forward

Future work should continue to reduce accidental complexity without flattening meaningful distinctions. The two Zero guides should stay separate in purpose. Public URLs should remain stable and understandable. Shared implementation should be shared only where that makes maintenance safer. Measurement should remain useful but modest. And the repository should continue to serve as both the production source and the project's institutional memory.

In one sentence

The project has moved from rebuilding a website to establishing a durable public system: a quiet invitation, a preserved body of work, two carefully bounded guides, privacy-first learning, and a repository that makes the whole undertaking maintainable over time.